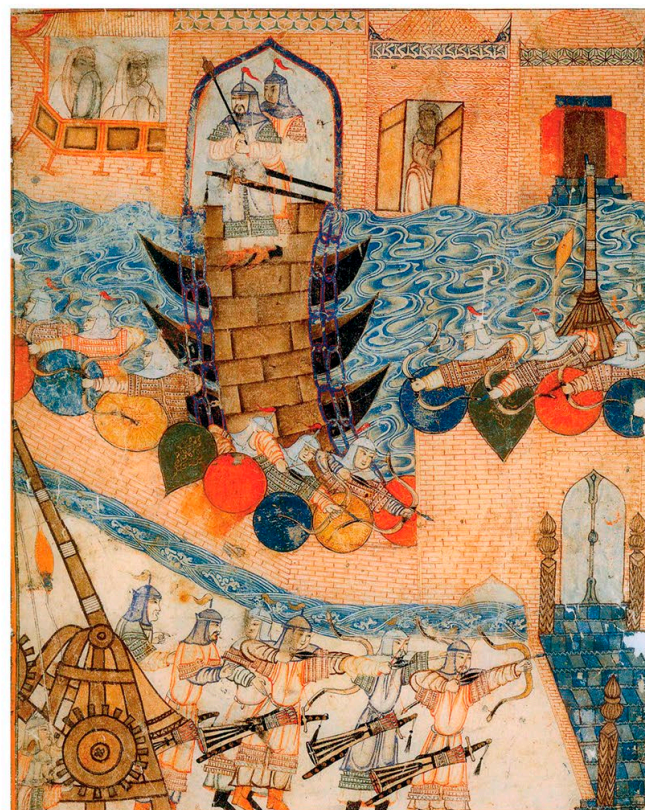


“They swept through the city... like raging wolves attacking sheep.”

14TH-CENTURY PERSIAN HISTORIAN WASSAF
DESCRIBING THE MONGOL SACK OF BAGHDAD



1258

SACK OF BAGHDAD

Baghdad was the seat of the Abbasid caliphs, leaders of the Islamic world since 750 CE. In 1258, Hulegu, khan of the western Mongol Empire, defeated the Abbasid army in battle and encircled Baghdad, which fell after a short siege. The Mongols showed no mercy, killing the caliph and massacring the city's entire population.

1240

1241 A Mongol
army defeats
Christian knights in
Poland at the Battle
of Liegnitz

1244 Japanese Zen master
Dogen founds Eihei-ji, the
first temple of Soto Zen
Buddhism in Japan

1242

BATTLE ON THE ICE

In April 1242, Prince Alexander Nevsky, a Russian hero, led the army of the city of Novgorod into battle against Prussian Teutonic Knights on the frozen ice of Lake Peipus. After hard fighting, the Knights were forced to retreat, many drowning as the weight of their armour caused the ice to crack. The battle ended Teutonic hopes of conquering Russia.

▷ Alexander Nevsky
monument in Pskov, Russia



△ Battle of Muret in the Albigensian Crusade

1244

ALBIGENSIAN HERESY CRUSHED

Albigensianism was an unorthodox form of Christianity that had a mass following in southern France. In 1209, the Catholic Church declared a crusade against these heretics, known as Cathars. Their last stronghold at Montségur fell in March 1244. About 250 Cathars were burned to death on the spot.